

BIRKEN LAKESIDE RESORT • SINCE 1906

GUEST TERMS & CONDITIONS

Woodsmoke. Pristine water. Good people.

FOR INDIVIDUAL CABIN & GLAMPING BOOKINGS

2026 SEASON • EFFECTIVE APRIL 1, 2026

WELCOME

COME AS YOU ARE.

Birken Lakeside Resort is a historic cabin resort on Gates Lake, in the BC coastal mountains. We have been here since 1906. The terms below are the practical bits — what we ask of you, what you can ask of us, and how it all works once you've booked.

Read them once. Then come find the dock.

A NOTE ON WEDDINGS & GATHERINGS

Weddings, retreats, group gatherings, and full-resort buyouts are governed by a separate Event Agreement. The terms in this document apply to individual cabin and glamping bookings. For event terms, contact us at hello@birkenlakesideresort.ca.

01 • ABOUT US & WHO CAN BOOK

BOOKING WITH US.

The lead guest

The lead guest is the person whose name is on the booking. They must be at least 18 years old. By placing a booking, the lead guest agrees to these terms on behalf of everyone in their party.

If someone else is booking on the lead guest's behalf, that person may be held responsible for cancellations, non-arrivals, or damages — so make sure the right name is on the reservation.

Who can stay

Only the lead guest and the named booking party are permitted to use the cabin and the property. Day visitors and third-party guests require permission from us in advance.

Occupancy & extra guests

Capacity figures listed for each cabin are **inclusive of all guests aged 5 and over**. Children under 5 do not count toward capacity and stay free.

Extra guests above the listed cabin capacity are **\$30 per person, per night**, arranged in advance with us. Cabins have firm maximum occupancies that cannot be exceeded.

02 • BOOKINGS & PAYMENTS

HOW IT WORKS.

Accepted methods

Credit or debit card (online or by phone), digital bank transfer, cheque, or cash deposit. If a cheque or transfer is returned and we incur bank charges, those charges are the lead guest's responsibility and must be reimbursed within seven (7) days.

Deposit

A **25% deposit** is required to confirm a cabin or glamping booking. The deposit is non-refundable — but it never disappears either. If you cancel, the deposit becomes a credit toward a future stay with us (see Cancellations below).

Balance

The remaining 75% of the booking is due and payable **30 days prior** to your arrival date.

03 • CANCELLATIONS & CHANGES

IF PLANS CHANGE.

We get it — plans change. Please let us know as early as you can. The earlier we know, the more flexibility we have.

Cabin & glamping bookings

All cancellation requests must be made in writing — email is fine — to hello@birkenlakesideresort.ca.

- **30 or more days before arrival:** The 75% balance is fully refundable. The 25% deposit becomes a credit toward a future stay with us — no blackout dates, no expiry games.
- **Inside 30 days of arrival:** The full booking amount is forfeit. No refund or future-stay credit.
- **Non-arrivals:** Guests who do not arrive forfeit the full booking amount.

Travel insurance

We strongly recommend guests take out travel or trip-cancellation insurance to cover unexpected events. We are a small resort — we cannot absorb the cost of last-minute changes the way a large hotel chain can.

Resort-initiated cancellation

If we have to cancel your booking due to circumstances beyond our control — fire, flood, road closure, force majeure — our liability is limited to a refund of payments already made. We also

reserve the right to cancel a booking without refund if guests are found to be in breach of these terms.

04 • ARRIVAL, DEPARTURE & YOUR STAY

THE BASICS.

Check-in & check-out

Check-in: 4:00 PM on the day of arrival.

Check-out: 11:00 AM on the day of departure.

Early check-in and late check-out can sometimes be arranged. Just ask.

Minimum nights

- **Standard minimum:** 2 nights.
- **Long weekends:** 3 nights.

Quiet hours

Sound carries over water — what feels conversational on your porch can land clearly across the lake. Out of respect for neighbours, fellow guests, and the wildlife that lives here year-round, we ask for quiet between 10:00 PM and 8:00 AM.

Quiet hours mean: voices down, music off (or in headphones), no loud games or generators, no fire-pit gatherings beyond your cabin's guests. Daytime, use the property however suits you — kids splashing, music on the dock, conversation around the fire is what we're here for.

Parties are permitted only when the entire property has been booked as a buyout, under that separate agreement. We reserve the right to end a stay immediately, without refund, if guests cause repeated disturbance.

Smoking & cannabis

Birken sits in a wildfire-sensitive corridor, and our cabins are over a century old. The rules here aren't bureaucratic — they're how the place is still standing.

- Smoking and vaping of any kind — tobacco, cannabis, vapes, e-cigarettes — is permitted only in designated, sign-posted outdoor areas. Never inside cabins, on cabin porches, or in any common building.
- Cannabis consumption follows the same rule. BC law permits cannabis use on private property at the property owner's discretion; ours is restricted to the same designated outdoor areas as tobacco. Edibles are permitted inside cabins; combustion is not.
- All smoking materials must be fully extinguished in the sand buckets provided. Never on the ground, never in the forest, never over a railing.

- Smoking inside a cabin will result in a **\$500 deep-cleaning fee** and may end your stay immediately without refund.

Parking

Free on-site parking, at the vehicle owner's risk. Cars and small RVs both fit. Please park in your assigned space.

Accessibility — please read

Honesty is our rule here. Cabins are accessed via stairs over uneven terrain. The property is not wheelchair-accessible. Service animals are welcome. The Meeting Hall (used for weddings) has a wheelchair ramp; the central washroom does not.

If anyone in your party has mobility considerations, please contact us before booking so we can talk it through honestly. Under-promising is far better than over-promising.

05 • PETS, WILDLIFE & THE OUTDOORS

HOSTING IN SOMEONE ELSE'S HABITAT.

Birken sits in a wilderness area. Bears, mountain goats, ospreys, and loons are our neighbours. We're not a hotel — we're guests in their home, and we ask the same of you.

Pets — we are PAW Pet Friendly

Dogs are part of the brand. They are welcome at Birken with a few ground rules:

- **\$15 per night, per pet**, cleaning charge.
- Pets must be leashed anywhere on the property.
- Pets are not permitted on the beach.
- Pets are not permitted in common buildings — the Grille, the General Store, the Meeting Hall, or the central washroom.
- Owners must clean up after their pets. Every time.

Food storage

All food must be stored inside cabins. Never on porches, decks, picnic tables, or in unsecured coolers. This is a wildlife-safety rule, not a suggestion — bears are real, and a habituated bear is a dead bear.

Fire safety

We're in a coastal mountain forest. A wildfire here doesn't just threaten property — it threatens neighbours, wildlife, and the road in and out. Treat fire with the seriousness the setting demands.

- **Campfires & fire pits.** Only in our designated, on-property fire rings, and only when BC fire bans permit. We post current fire restrictions at the General Store and on the Meeting Hall noticeboard. When a ban is in effect, no open flames of any kind — anywhere, including BBQs in some cases. Check before you light.
- **Cabin wood stoves.** Use only the firewood we provide (\$18/crate from the General Store). No outside wood — it carries pests we are legally required to keep out of the area. Use indoors only. Close the stove door before bed.
- **BBQs.** Use only the BBQs provided. Keep them on the deck pad, away from railings and overhangs. Never move them inside or under a cover while hot.
- **Candles, incense & open flames inside cabins are not permitted.** No exceptions, including for weddings or celebrations within an individual cabin. Battery-operated candles are welcome and we'll happily point you to ours.
- **Fireworks, sparklers, sky lanterns, and any incendiary device are strictly prohibited** anywhere on the property. This is non-negotiable. Guests found using them will be asked to leave immediately without refund and may be reported to local authorities.
- **If you see fire or smoke that isn't ours,** call 911 first, then find any staff member. There's a fire extinguisher in every cabin and at every common building — know where yours is.

Wildlife

Common sightings: black bears, mountain goats, ospreys, loons. Less common but present: cougars, deer. Keep a respectful distance, do not feed anything, and do not leave children or pets unattended near the lake or treeline.

Cell service

Cell service is spotty north of Pemberton. We recommend downloading offline maps before you leave home.

06 • PROPERTY & SERVICES

WHAT'S HERE, AND HOW IT WORKS.

Mountain Wi-Fi

Solid Wi-Fi across the property — cabins and common buildings. Use it sparingly. That's by design. It works for browsing, postcards, the occasional email. It is not built for heavy streaming, gaming, or large downloads, and we monitor usage to keep it fair for everyone.

Illegal activity over our network is strictly prohibited and will be reported to the appropriate authorities.

Damages

The lead guest is responsible for any damage caused by their party to cabin furniture, fixtures, or fittings. Accidents happen — report damage to us as soon as it occurs so we can minimise the cost and the disruption to the next guest.

Keys

Lost keys will incur a replacement charge.

Lost property

Items left behind are held for one month. We're happy to return them by mail — postage at the owner's expense. After one month, unclaimed items are donated or disposed of. We are not responsible for replacing items lost on the property.

07 • PRIVACY

YOUR INFORMATION.

We collect only the personal information we need to manage your booking — name, contact details, and payment information. We hold it securely and in accordance with British Columbia's Personal Information Protection Act (PIPA) and the federal Personal Information Protection and Electronic Documents Act (PIPEDA).

How we use it

- To process and manage your booking.
- To communicate with you before, during, and after your stay.
- To send you occasional updates from Birken — only if you opt in. You can unsubscribe at any time.

How long we keep it

Booking records are kept for as long as legally required (typically 12 months for active records, longer for accounting and tax purposes). We do not sell guest information. Ever.

The guest book

The on-site guest book is a Birken tradition. Please do not write sensitive personal information in it — it lives in a public space, and entries that include private details may be removed to protect your privacy.

GET IN TOUCH

WE'RE HERE.

PHONE	(604) 452-3255
EMAIL	hello@birkenlakesideresort.ca
WEB	birkenlakesideresort.ca
FIND US	Birken, British Columbia · Gates Lake

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